Georgia Oak, Stone Mountain Oak

Quercus georgiana

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Passage: 3 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available

Not available

Flower
Not available



Leaf close-up
Library candidate

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 15–30 ft typical in wild (up to 40–50 ft in cultivation or deep soil). Confirmed by Wikipedia/FNA (8–15 m / 26–49 ft), plant lust (30–50 ft), Cornell notes (smaller). × 20–40 ft. Variable; often multi-stemmed or shrubby.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Native to north Georgia (Stone Mountain and nearby granitic outcrops). Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 5–8/9. Often small or shrubby on rock outcrops; can reach 30–50 ft in cultivation or better soils. Perfect for Atlanta Piedmont. Prefers dry, well-drained, granitic or rocky sites. Fall color orange-scarlet possible. Rare and local native. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 25–50 ft, rare native of granitic outcrops, well-drained soils required, reddish fall color. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/quercus-georgiana/]
Sun: Full sun. Intolerant of shade.
Water: Dry to medium. Prefers well-drained. Drought tolerant on rock outcrops.
Soil: Well-drained, rocky, granitic, dry slopes and knolls. Acidic preferred. Adaptable in cultivation if well-drained.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun in well-drained, preferably rocky or sandy soil. Water until established. Excellent for dry Piedmont sites or rock gardens. Slow growth. Suitable as small specimen or native landscape tree. Protect from heavy shade.
Soil prep: Well-drained, rocky, granitic, dry slopes and knolls. Acidic preferred. Adaptable in cultivation if well-drained.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Granitic outcrops, dry slopes and knolls, Stone Mountain area and similar monadnocks. Elev. 50–500 m.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Small tree or large shrub. Often multi-stemmed or low in wild; more tree-like in cultivation. Slow growing. Rounded or irregular.
Foliage: Orange to scarlet (variable; can be bright).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Gray to light brown, scaly.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally tough on native sites. Possible oak pests. Verticillium wilt resistant noted in some nursery sources. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence thin. No serious problems stated.
Not stated
Additional:
- Rare native of Georgia granite outcrops. - Leaves with 3–5(–7) lobes, glossy. - Small acorns. - Cultivated as specimen in Zones 5–8. - Distinct from more common oaks.

Sources: - Flora of North America - Wikipedia (cross-checked) - Cornell Botanic Gardens - Plant Lust / nursery notes - Multiple botanical references